SSC CGL & RRB NTPC Medieval History MCQs

High-Yield Previous Year Questions (Maratha Empire, Bhakti/Sufi Movements, and Central Sultanate Administration)

Q1. Which of the following taxes was collected by the Maratha Empire from neighboring territories outside its direct rule as a protection fee against raids?

A) Bhaga

B) Sardeshmukhi

C) Chouth

D) Bali

Correct Answer: C) Chouth

Exam Source: RRB NTPC CBT-2 (Level 6) – 9th May 2022 (Shift 1)

Explanation: Chouth (meaning one-fourth) was a military tax equivalent to 25% of the standard land revenue. It was levied on neighboring non-Maratha territories (like Mughal provinces) to guarantee they would not be raided by Maratha forces. Sardeshmukhi was a separate 10% additional levy claimed by Shivaji Maharaj based on his position as the hereditary supreme head (Sardesmukh) of the region.

Q2. Who among the following Sufi saints of the Chishti order was popularly addressed by his followers as 'Mahbub-i-Ilahi' (Beloved of God)?

A) Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti

B) Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya

C) Baba Farid

D) Shaikh Salim Chishti

Correct Answer: B) Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya

Exam Source: SSC CGL Tier-1 Exam – 14th July 2023 (Shift 2)

Explanation: Based in Delhi, Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya was a highly influential saint of the Chishti Silsila who earned the title Mahbub-i-Ilahi. He was legendary for his strict policy of political detachment, famously witnessing the reigns of seven different Delhi Sultans but choosing never to visit the royal court of any.

Q3. In the administrative system of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj known as the 'Ashta Pradhan', which minister looked after foreign affairs and royal ceremonies?

A) Amatya

B) Peshwa

C) Waqia-Navis

D) Sumant (Dabir)

Correct Answer: D) Sumant (Dabir)

Exam Source: RRB NTPC CBT-1 Exam – 5th January 2021 (Shift 2)

Explanation: The Sumant (also called Dabir) acted as the Foreign Minister. His job was to manage relations with foreign powers, receive incoming diplomats, and handle official state protocol and court ceremonies. For comparison,

the Amatya acted as the Finance Minister and the Peshwa was the Prime Minister who handled general administration.

Q4. The famous 15th-century Nirguna Bhakti saint Kabir Das was a contemporary of which ruler of the Delhi Sultanate?

A) Alauddin Khalji

B) Sikandar Lodi

C) Muhammad bin Tughlaq

D) Ibrahim Lodi

Correct Answer: B) Sikandar Lodi

Exam Source: SSC CGL Tier-1 Exam – 3rd December 2022 (Shift 3)

Explanation: Sant Kabir Das lived during the 15th and early 16th centuries, directly overlapping with the rule of Sikandar Lodi (the Sultan who founded Agra). Kabir belonged to the Nirguna school, meaning he worshipped a formless supreme being. His teachings—which criticized orthodox religious rituals in both Hinduism and Islam—were compiled by his disciples into the famous text Bijak.

Q5. Which medieval ruler introduced the standardized silver coin called 'Rupiya', which laid the foundation for the currency system later adopted by the Mughals and the British?

A) Akbar

B) Iltutmish

C) Sher Shah Suri

D) Muhammad bin Tughlaq

Correct Answer: C) Sher Shah Suri

Exam Source: SSC CGL Tier-1 Exam – 18th July 2023 (Shift 4)

Explanation: During his brief five-year rule (1540–1545 AD), the Sur Dynasty founder Sher Shah Suri completely overhauled the subcontinent's economy. He introduced a standardized silver coin weighing 178 grains called the Rupiya. This coin format was so successful that it was retained by the Mughal Empire, copied by the East India Company, and eventually evolved into modern India's currency.

Q6. The historic 'Treaty of Purandar' (1665 AD) was signed between Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj and which commander representing the Mughal Emperor Aurangzeb?

A) Shaista Khan

B) Raja Jai Singh I

C) Afzal Khan

D) Mir Jumla

Correct Answer: B) Raja Jai Singh I

Exam Source: RRB NTPC CBT-1 Exam – 1st March 2021 (Shift 1)

Explanation: After the Mughals launched a massive and highly destructive siege on Maratha territories, Shivaji Maharaj was forced into negotiations. He signed the Treaty of Purandar in 1665 with Raja Jai Singh I, a powerful Rajput general sent by Aurangzeb. Under the harsh terms of this treaty, Shivaji had to surrender 23 out of his 35 forts to the Mughal Empire.

Q7. The celebrated Hindu philosopher Adi Shankaracharya (8th Century AD) is famous for propounding which of the following schools of philosophy?

A) Advaita Vedanta

B) Vishishtadvaita

C) Dvaita

D) Shuddhadvaita

Correct Answer: A) Advaita Vedanta

Exam Source: RRB NTPC CBT-1 Exam – 12th February 2021 (Shift 2)

Explanation: Adi Shankaracharya revived Vedic philosophy by consolidating the school of Advaita Vedanta (Strict Monism/Non-dualism). This philosophy states that the individual soul (Atman) and ultimate reality (Brahman) are fundamentally identical. He traveled across India establishing four core monasteries (Mathas) to unify the faith: Badrinath (North), Puri (East), Sringeri (South), and Dwarka (West).

Q8. The department named 'Diwan-i-Arz' in the central administration of the Delhi Sultanate was primarily responsible for which sector?

A) Royal Correspondence

B) Religious Endowments

C) Military Affairs

D) Finance and Revenue

Correct Answer: C) Military Affairs

Exam Source: RRB NTPC CBT-2 (Level 6) – 9th May 2022 (Shift 1)

Explanation: Diwan-i-Arz was the military department responsible for recruiting soldiers, managing salaries, and keeping regular troop counts. It was established as a highly organized independent ministry by Sultan Ghiyasuddin Balban to defend the Sultanate from continuous Mongol invasions and crush local rebellions.

Q9. Who was the spiritual guru of the famous Maratha ruler Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj?

A) Sant Tukaram

B) Samarth Ramdas

C) Sant Eknath

D) Sant Jnaneshwar

Correct Answer: B) Samarth Ramdas

Exam Source: RRB NTPC CBT-1 Exam – 18th April 2016 (Shift 1)

Explanation: Sant Samarth Ramdas was a highly influential 17th-century Bhakti saint of Maharashtra and the spiritual guide (guru) of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj. He is celebrated for composing the monumental text Dasbodh, which blends spiritual wisdom with practical guidance on life, governance, and societal duty. His teachings played a vital role in inspiring the cultural revival of the region.

Q10. The ruins of the medieval capital city of the Vijayanagara Empire are currently located at which UNESCO World Heritage site?

A) Halebidu

B) Thanjavur

C) Hampi

D) Badami

Correct Answer: C) Hampi

Exam Source: RRB NTPC CBT-1 Exam – 28th March 2016 (Shift 1)

Explanation: The magnificent capital of the Vijayanagara Empire (founded in 1336 AD by the brothers Harihara and Bukka) was located at Hampi along the banks of the Tungabhadra River in modern-day Karnataka. Hampi was a bustling global trade hub famous for its grand temples and architecture until it was defeated and ruined following the Battle of Talikota in 1565 AD. Today, it stands as a major UNESCO World Heritage site.